IELTS ACADEMIC · STUDENT WORKSHEET

IELTS Academic Set 40

All sections

Name: _____ Date: _____

HOW TO USE THIS WORKSHEET

Work through each IELTS part in order. Reading passages stay with their questions; charts and diagrams appear next to their tasks. Open the live practice page for Listening audio and Speaking recordings.

Staff solutions and scripts are supplied separately.

Listening

Use the separately supplied audio. Write one response for each question.

You will hear four recordings. Each recording is played once.

Answer Questions 1-40. Follow the instruction and word limit printed for each group.

At the end, check your answers before submitting.

Part 1

Questions 1-6

Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

1. Customer surname: _____

2. Instrument: _____

3. Ear causing concern: _____

4. Selected filter: _____ strength

5. Mould colour: _____

6. Hearing check: _____ May

Questions 7-7

Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER for your answer.

7. What should Dylan avoid before impressions?

Questions 8-8

Write NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS for your answer.

8. Which piece of stage equipment should he bring to the fitting?

Questions 9-10

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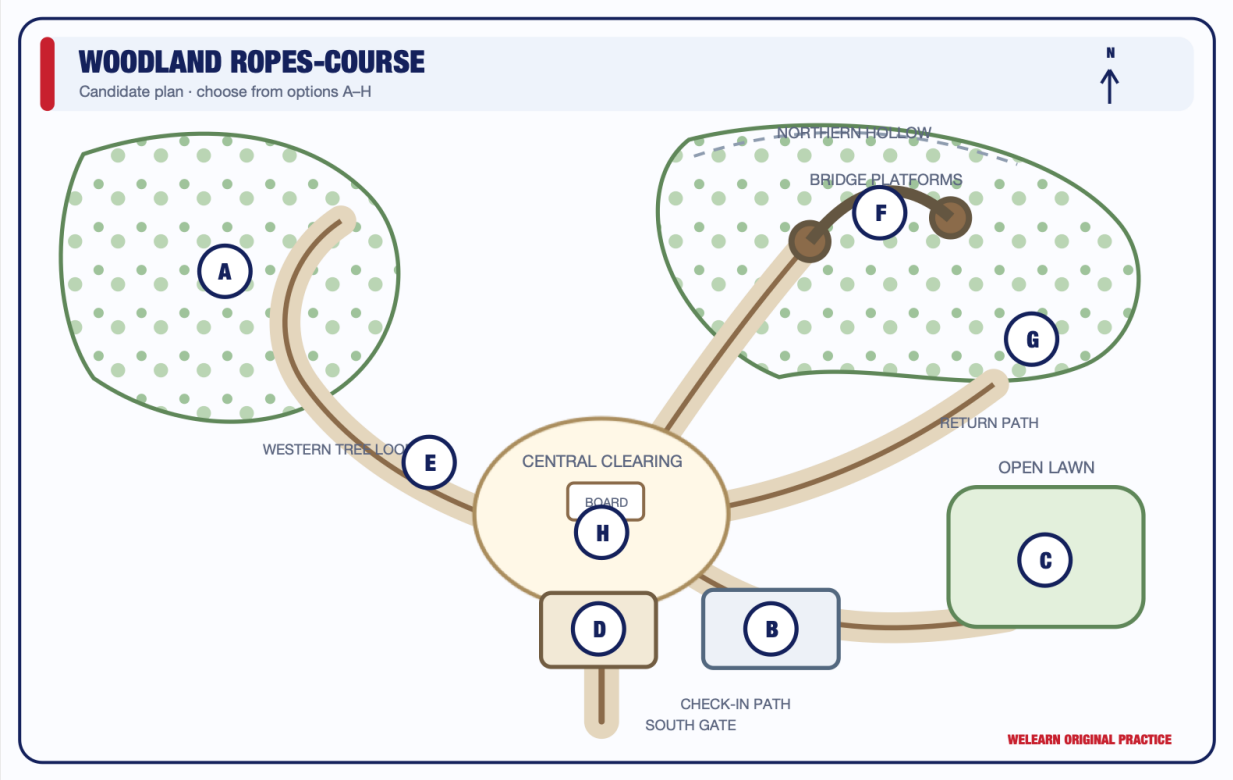
Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

9. When will the finished plugs be ready?

10. Where will the final seal be checked?

Part 2

Candidate map / plan



Questions 11-16

Choose the correct answer.

11. Check-in lodge

- **A** Location A
- **B** Location B
- **C** Location C
- **D** Location D
- **E** Location E
- **F** Location F
- **G** Location G
- **H** Location H

12. Harness bay

13. Practice zone

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14. Junior loop

15. High bridge

16. Emergency assembly point

Questions 17-20

Choose the correct answer.

17. Blue route

- **A** harness-bay attendant
- **B** platform instructor
- **C** ground marshal
- **D** route controller

18. Red route

19. Equipment return

20. Ground observation

Part 3

Questions 21-25

Choose the correct answer.

21. What is the main outcome of the study?

- **A** the number of ideas written on the board
- **B** the distribution of speaking turns
- **C** students' preference for the room

22. Why will every seminar group have the same size?

- **A** to simplify room bookings
- **B** to use fewer microphones
- **C** to prevent group size affecting participation

23. Why do they choose audio rather than video recording?

- **A** it records the required behaviour with less intrusive data
- **B** it automatically scores every contribution
- **C** it removes the need for consent

24. What weakness appeared in the pilot?

- **A** students changed seats during the class
- **B** the tutor used prompts inconsistently
- **C** the room microphones stopped recording

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25. How will they control for order effects?

A allow students to select a layout

B repeat only the most successful layout

C rotate the layout order between groups

Questions 26-30

Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

26. Participants: _____ students

27. Students in each group: _____

28. Observers will record spoken _____.

29. Baseline measure: speaking _____

30. Follow-up interview: _____ minutes

Part 4

Questions 31-36

Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

31. An atmospheric river transports concentrated _____.

32. It is typically a relatively _____ corridor.

33. Much of the moisture comes from the _____.

34. Rising terrain causes _____ uplift.

35. Cooling can produce intense _____.

36. In cold basins the event may add to the _____.

Questions 37-40

Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS for each answer.

37. Forecast impacts depend strongly on the exact landfall _____.

38. Forecasters also estimate the event’s _____.

39. Recent wildfire areas may face rapid _____.

40. Public forecasts should communicate an uncertainty _____.

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Reading

Read the three passages and answer Questions 1-40. Follow the word limit shown for each completion task.

Pipes fired for the underground city

A As towns expanded, drains that had once served a few buildings had to carry waste and storm water over longer distances. Open channels leaked, smelled and were easily obstructed. Builders needed pipes that could be produced in repeated lengths, laid underground and resist constant contact with moisture. Fired clay offered compressive strength and did not rot, but ordinary porous earthenware could absorb water. Salt glazing helped turn the surface into a denser barrier.

B Prepared clay was pushed through a die or shaped in moulds to make a hollow cylinder. Consistent wall thickness mattered: a thin patch could fail during firing, while an uneven pipe was difficult to align in a trench. Workers formed a widened socket at one end so that the plain end of the next pipe could enter it. Before firing, lengths were dried gradually. Rapid drying created cracks that a glaze could not repair.

C Near the hottest stage of firing, salt was introduced into the kiln. Sodium compounds in the vapour reacted with silica and alumina at the clay surface, producing a glass-like skin. The characteristic texture was not a painted coating added after firing; it formed through a reaction during the firing itself. Kiln conditions varied, so colour and coverage were not perfectly uniform. A glossy appearance alone could not guarantee that a pipe was sound throughout its wall.

D Manufacturers rejected lengths that had warped, cracked or fused to their supports. A clear ringing sound when tapped could suggest successful firing, whereas a dull response might indicate a defect, but visual and dimensional checks were also required. Straightness was especially important because small deviations accumulated across a long sewer run. Standardised diameters made replacement and connection easier, turning the pipe from a local craft item into a component of a larger engineered network.

E At installation, the plain end of one pipe entered the socket of another. The surrounding gap was packed and sealed with jointing material. A rigid seal prevented soil from entering, but poor workmanship could leave a route for leakage or root intrusion. Bedding beneath the pipe distributed loads from the ground above. Durable clay could still break if supported at isolated points or struck during backfilling; material strength did not compensate for a badly prepared trench.

F The glazed interior absorbed little water and offered a relatively smooth path for flow. Sediment was less likely to cling than on a rough surface, although insufficient slope could still allow solids to settle. Engineers therefore considered diameter and gradient together. Making a pipe larger did not automatically improve performance if flow became too shallow to carry deposits. The network worked as a system whose joints, alignment and operating conditions were as important as the ceramic body.

G Salt-glazed pipes helped nineteenth-century towns extend underground drainage, and many remained in service for long periods. Later concerns about manufacturing emissions and the arrival of other materials changed production. Existing clay networks also revealed weaknesses at joints or where ground movement occurred. Their history shows why infrastructure cannot be judged by material alone. Successful adoption combined industrial manufacture, standard dimensions, careful installation and public investment in connected sewers.

H Surveyors had to establish a fall that carried flow while keeping trenches within workable depths. Existing foundations, watercourses and property boundaries constrained the alignment. Inspection points were placed where direction changed or branches joined, giving maintenance crews access without excavating the whole line. These decisions were invisible after the street reopened, but they determined whether blockage could be located and whether later extensions had somewhere to connect. Construction also had to proceed in short sections so streets did not remain impassable indefinitely. Excavated soil occupied space beside the trench, delivery carts needed access, and unexpected ground water could interrupt work. The logistics above ground were inseparable from the geometry planned below it.

I When old pipes are uncovered, their condition offers a record of both manufacture and installation. A well-fired length may remain intact beside a displaced joint, pointing to ground movement rather than material decay. Conversely, repeated cracking at the same position can indicate poor bedding. Archaeological observation therefore prevents simple claims that one material either succeeded or failed. The network aged as a combination of ceramic units, seals, soil and changing loads

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above.

Recovering a nutrient as crystal

A Wastewater treatment has traditionally been judged by what it prevents from reaching rivers. Phosphorus is one target because excessive discharge can stimulate unwanted biological growth downstream. Yet phosphorus is also an essential plant nutrient obtained from finite mineral deposits. These two facts support a different question: can a treatment plant recover phosphorus in a useful form rather than merely transfer it into sludge? One established route produces struvite, a crystalline compound containing phosphate, ammonium and magnesium. Recovery turns part of a pollution-control task into a resource operation, although it does not make every treatment stream equally suitable.

B The final treated water contains a large volume of liquid but often a relatively dilute nutrient load. Recovery is usually more practical in smaller side-streams where phosphorus has become concentrated during sludge processing. Liquid separated after anaerobic digestion and dewatering is one example. Selecting such a stream reduces the volume sent through a recovery reactor and increases the chance that dissolved ions will meet often enough to form crystals. Feed composition still varies over time, so operators sample the liquor rather than relying only on an annual average.

C Struvite can form unintentionally inside pipes, pumps and valves when its component ions encounter favourable conditions. A hard deposit narrows passages and creates maintenance problems. Deliberate recovery uses the same tendency under controlled conditions. Instead of allowing crystals to appear throughout the plant, operators direct a phosphate-rich liquor into a vessel designed for growth and collection. This concentration of growth also lets staff inspect and remove the mineral at planned intervals. The mineral has not changed; its location, timing and management have. This reversal explains why a substance once treated only as scale can become a planned product.

D Crystal growth depends on chemical balance. If magnesium is insufficient, a magnesium source may be added. Operators also adjust the liquid towards an alkaline pH at which the required ions combine more readily. Mixing keeps reactants in contact, but excessive turbulence can break developing particles or carry them out before they grow. Other dissolved ions compete for reaction sites and may create different solids. Successful control therefore involves composition, pH and hydraulic conditions together, rather than a single universal setting.

E A reactor can retain small seed particles on which new mineral accumulates. In a fluidised design, upward-moving liquid suspends the particles while allowing heavier pellets to remain long enough to enlarge. Operators balance the flow: it must prevent material settling into an inactive mass without washing useful crystals away. Periodically, larger pellets are withdrawn and smaller ones continue through another growth cycle. Seeding makes nucleation more predictable, but it cannot compensate for a feed with too little recoverable phosphorus.

F Freshly harvested crystals carry water and traces of the treatment stream. They are separated, washed and dried before grading. A consistent particle size simplifies storage and application, while laboratory analysis confirms nutrient content. Struvite releases nutrients more slowly than highly soluble fertilisers under many conditions, which may suit some crops and soils. That property is not an automatic advantage everywhere: users need a product whose release pattern matches plant demand and local management.

G The origin of a recovered mineral raises questions about contaminants. Metals, pathogens or unwanted organic compounds may enter with the feed, even if the crystal lattice itself favours particular ions. Product testing and clear standards are therefore essential before agricultural use. A high phosphorus recovery percentage says little about safety or consistency. Plants may redirect a lower-risk side-stream, add a polishing step or reject batches outside specification. Recovery counts as successful only when the output is usable, not simply when phosphorus disappears from the liquid.

H Economics depend strongly on concentration, chemical inputs, reactor scale and the value of avoided maintenance. At a site already troubled by mineral deposits, planned crystallisation may reduce cleaning interruptions as well as produce saleable pellets. Revenue from crystals may offset costs, but it rarely tells the whole story. Energy, transport, residual sludge and the destination of the product belong in a life-cycle assessment. Nor should struvite be treated as the only recovery option; other phosphate minerals or routes from ash may suit different facilities. The strongest case arises where a concentrated stream, reliable product market and operational benefit coincide. Resource recovery is thus a design choice within a larger treatment system, not a universal attachment for every plant.

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Reading what the eye cannot see

A Some manuscripts contain more writing than a reader can see. When parchment was scarce, an earlier text might be scraped or washed away so that the sheet could be used again. The upper script may remain clear while traces underneath survive only as faint strokes, stains or changes in the skin. Such a reused page is called a palimpsest. Recovering its earlier layer is not simply a matter of making every dark mark brighter, because the visible ink, erased ink, parchment and later damage can overlap.

B Multispectral imaging exploits the fact that ink and support materials do not absorb and reflect light identically at every wavelength. A feature almost invisible in ordinary colour may separate from its background under ultraviolet, visible or infrared illumination. Technicians therefore record a sequence of narrow spectral bands rather than trusting one photograph. These aligned frames form an image stack. There is no universal best band: the useful contrast depends on the composition and condition of both the writing material and the page.

C Although the camera need not touch the manuscript, non-contact does not mean risk-free. A conservator first checks weak sewing, flaking pigments and the angle through which a bound volume can safely open. A cradle supports the book while cool, controlled lamps limit heat and exposure. Reference targets placed beside the page help record brightness and colour response. This preparation can appear slower than photography itself, but it protects the object and makes images from different sessions more comparable.

D The separate frames must correspond pixel for pixel before they are combined. Even slight page movement, camera vibration or curvature can shift a letter between channels. Registration software aligns stable features, while images of dark and light references help correct uneven illumination and detector response. If these steps are weak, processing may create coloured fringes or apparent edges that never existed on the page. Calibration is therefore part of the evidence, not a cosmetic adjustment applied after discovery.

E Once the stack is corrected, analysts can compare bands directly, calculate ratios or construct false-colour views. Statistical methods such as principal component analysis reorganise correlated measurements so that uncommon variations may stand out. Independent component methods attempt a different separation of mixed signals. Neither technique knows what a word ought to say, and a dramatic image is not automatically the most reliable one. Analysts test several outputs because a method that isolates one ink may also emphasise folds, dirt or bleed-through.

F An enhanced stroke still has to be interpreted. Ruling lines, worm damage and writing visible from the reverse can resemble letters when contrast is pushed too far. Imaging specialists understand how an output was produced, whereas palaeographers compare character shapes, abbreviations and writing habits. Their collaboration prevents software artefacts from being promoted into new words. Uncertain readings remain uncertain: responsible editions distinguish clearly observed letters from reconstructions, even when the reconstructed phrase seems historically plausible.

G Spectral imaging is valuable because it surveys a whole surface and shows where materials differ, but it does not always identify their chemistry. Similar-looking mixtures can produce ambiguous signatures, especially when reference libraries contain no close match. A focused technique such as Raman spectroscopy can examine selected points with greater molecular specificity, although collecting those measurements is slower. The approaches are complementary: the broad image locates promising or puzzling regions, and targeted analysis can investigate why those regions behave differently.

H A processed picture is only one result of many choices. Future researchers need the raw image stack, calibration frames, registration record and settings used for each enhancement. Keeping these materials allows another team to repeat the sequence, question a correction or apply an improved method. Institutions should also record equipment, wavelengths and page orientation in durable metadata. An attractive final composite without that audit trail may communicate a discovery, yet it cannot show whether a disputed stroke came from the manuscript or the workflow.

I Recovered fragments can alter the reading of a poem, legal note or scientific argument, and digital surrogates can reduce repeated handling of a fragile original. Yet imaging does not restore material that has vanished, nor does it replace study of the physical book. The strongest claim is proportional to the chain of evidence: what the instrument recorded, how the frames were transformed and how specialists interpreted the marks. Used with that restraint, spectral imaging expands access to a manuscript’s hidden history without pretending to remove every doubt.

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1. Which paragraph clarifies that the glaze was formed inside the kiln?

A Paragraph A

B Paragraph B

C Paragraph C

D Paragraph D

E Paragraph E

F Paragraph F

G Paragraph G

H Paragraph H

I Paragraph I

2. Which paragraph warns that a larger diameter alone may not improve transport?

A Paragraph A

B Paragraph B

C Paragraph C

D Paragraph D

E Paragraph E

F Paragraph F

G Paragraph G

H Paragraph H

I Paragraph I

3. Which paragraph describes the production of a socket?

A Paragraph A

B Paragraph B

C Paragraph C

D Paragraph D

E Paragraph E

F Paragraph F

G Paragraph G

H Paragraph H

I Paragraph I

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4. Which paragraph describes the role of bedding below a pipe?

A Paragraph A

B Paragraph B

C Paragraph C

D Paragraph D

E Paragraph E

F Paragraph F

G Paragraph G

H Paragraph H

I Paragraph I

5. Which paragraph explains why porous earthenware was unsuitable for wet conditions?

A Paragraph A

B Paragraph B

C Paragraph C

D Paragraph D

E Paragraph E

F Paragraph F

G Paragraph G

H Paragraph H

I Paragraph I

6. Which paragraph explains why straightness mattered across multiple lengths?

A Paragraph A

B Paragraph B

C Paragraph C

D Paragraph D

E Paragraph E

F Paragraph F

G Paragraph G

H Paragraph H

I Paragraph I

7. What raw material was shaped into the pipe body?

8. What widened component received the next pipe?

9. What substance was introduced near the hottest firing stage?

10. What sound could indicate that firing had succeeded?

11. What entered a socket during installation?

12. What biological problem could a defective joint admit?

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13. Which dimension was considered together with gradient?

14. Paragraph A

i A former maintenance problem becomes a controlled product

ii Why the most dilute stream is always preferred

iii Several variables must be managed together

iv Preparing and assessing the recovered material

v A resource question added to pollution control

vi Why one recovery design suits every facility

vii A surface that supports predictable enlargement

viii Safety follows automatically from high recovery

15. Paragraph C

i A former maintenance problem becomes a controlled product

ii Why the most dilute stream is always preferred

iii Several variables must be managed together

iv Preparing and assessing the recovered material

v A resource question added to pollution control

vi Why one recovery design suits every facility

vii A surface that supports predictable enlargement

viii Safety follows automatically from high recovery

16. Paragraph D

i A former maintenance problem becomes a controlled product

ii Why the most dilute stream is always preferred

iii Several variables must be managed together

iv Preparing and assessing the recovered material

v A resource question added to pollution control

vi Why one recovery design suits every facility

vii A surface that supports predictable enlargement

viii Safety follows automatically from high recovery

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17. Paragraph E

i A former maintenance problem becomes a controlled product

ii Why the most dilute stream is always preferred

iii Several variables must be managed together

iv Preparing and assessing the recovered material

v A resource question added to pollution control

vi Why one recovery design suits every facility

vii A surface that supports predictable enlargement

viii Safety follows automatically from high recovery

18. Paragraph F

i A former maintenance problem becomes a controlled product

ii Why the most dilute stream is always preferred

iii Several variables must be managed together

iv Preparing and assessing the recovered material

v A resource question added to pollution control

vi Why one recovery design suits every facility

vii A surface that supports predictable enlargement

viii Safety follows automatically from high recovery

19. The final treated water is always the most practical feed for phosphorus recovery.

TRUE

FALSE

NOT GIVEN

20. Struvite can cause operational problems when it forms in uncontrolled locations.

TRUE

FALSE

NOT GIVEN

21. Crystal formation is influenced by chemical composition, pH and mixing conditions.

TRUE

FALSE

NOT GIVEN

22. A high phosphorus recovery percentage is sufficient proof that the product is safe.

TRUE

FALSE

NOT GIVEN

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23. The passage gives a fixed selling price for recovered struvite in every market.

TRUE

FALSE

NOT GIVEN

24. Small _____ provide a surface on which more mineral can accumulate.

25. The harvested crystals are washed and _____ before grading.

26. Standards and product tests help identify possible _____ in recovered material.

27. Multispectral imaging may reveal contrasts that ordinary colour viewing misses.

YES

NO

NOT GIVEN

28. The same spectral band is optimal for every combination of ink and support.

YES

NO

NOT GIVEN

29. Because image capture is non-contact, a conservator does not need to assess a fragile volume first.

YES

NO

NOT GIVEN

30. Poor registration between image channels can manufacture apparent outlines.

YES

NO

NOT GIVEN

31. The writer specifies one mandatory international file format for storing raw image stacks.

YES

NO

NOT GIVEN

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32. Which paragraph explains why records of processing choices must be retained?

A Paragraph A

B Paragraph B

C Paragraph C

D Paragraph D

E Paragraph E

F Paragraph F

G Paragraph G

H Paragraph H

I Paragraph I

33. Which paragraph describes physical support used before photographs are taken?

A Paragraph A

B Paragraph B

C Paragraph C

D Paragraph D

E Paragraph E

F Paragraph F

G Paragraph G

H Paragraph H

I Paragraph I

34. Which paragraph warns that an enhanced mark is not sufficient evidence of a letter?

A Paragraph A

B Paragraph B

C Paragraph C

D Paragraph D

E Paragraph E

F Paragraph F

G Paragraph G

H Paragraph H

I Paragraph I

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35. Which paragraph gives the physical reason that different bands may reveal different features?

A Paragraph A

B Paragraph B

C Paragraph C

D Paragraph D

E Paragraph E

F Paragraph F

G Paragraph G

H Paragraph H

I Paragraph I

36. Which paragraph argues that scholarly claims should remain proportionate to the evidence chain?

A Paragraph A

B Paragraph B

C Paragraph C

D Paragraph D

E Paragraph E

F Paragraph F

G Paragraph G

H Paragraph H

I Paragraph I

37. Which paragraph contrasts a broad survey with slower analysis at selected locations?

A Paragraph A

B Paragraph B

C Paragraph C

D Paragraph D

E Paragraph E

F Paragraph F

G Paragraph G

H Paragraph H

I Paragraph I

38. What is the main purpose of the passage?

A To argue that all erased manuscripts can now be read completely

B To explain how spectral imaging can recover hidden writing and why its results require controls

C To compare the market prices of manuscript cameras

D To recommend replacing physical manuscripts with digital copies

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39. Why does the writer describe Raman spectroscopy in paragraph G?

A To show that point analysis is always faster than imaging

B To claim that reference libraries are unnecessary

C To identify the only safe technique for parchment

D To illustrate how focused chemical analysis can complement a surface-wide survey

40. Which principle does the writer most strongly support?

A The most dramatic processed image should determine the reading.

B Calibration can be omitted when the hidden text looks plausible.

C Capture, processing and interpretation must remain traceable, with claims limited to the evidence.

D Digital access makes study of the physical book unnecessary.

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Writing

IELTS Academic Practice Set 40 - Writing

60 minutes

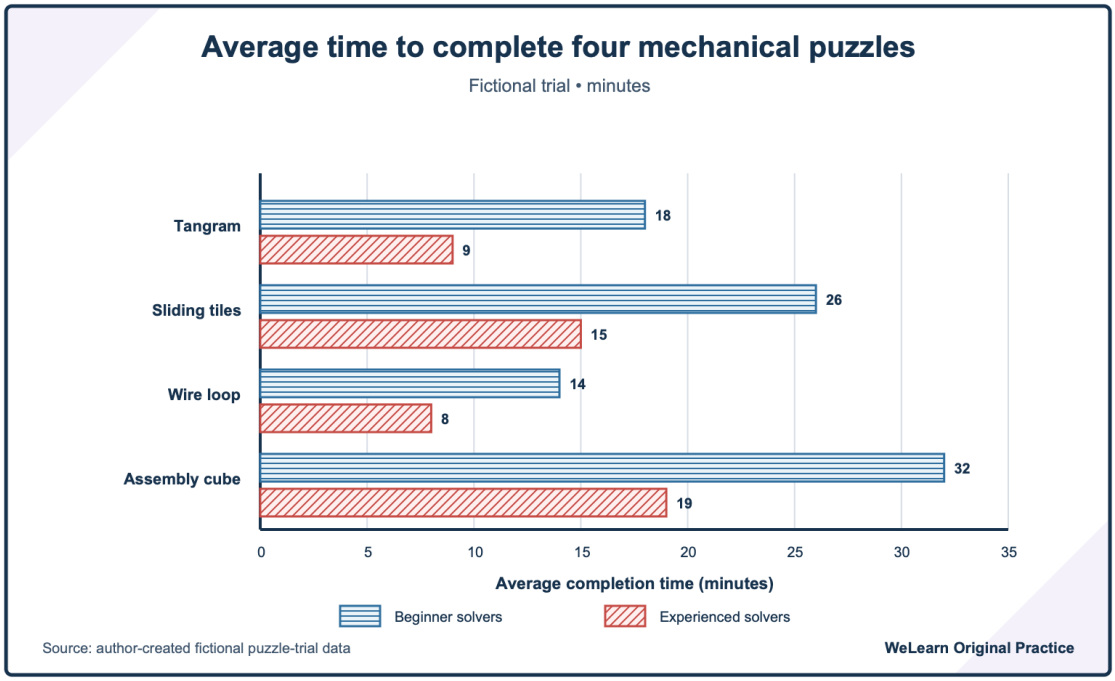
1

You should spend about 20 minutes on this task.

The bar chart below shows the average number of minutes taken by beginner and experienced solvers to complete four kinds of mechanical puzzle in a fictional trial.

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.

Write at least 150 words.



2

You should spend about 40 minutes on this task.

Some people propose that new city-centre developments should reserve some ground-floor space for non-commercial community use.

What are the advantages and disadvantages of this approach, and what is your own opinion?

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own knowledge or experience.

Write at least 250 words.

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Speaking

IELTS Speaking Practice Set 40

Part 1

- Good morning. My name is Michael Reed.
- What is your full name?
- What should I call you?
- What kinds of towels do you use in everyday life?
- When do you take a towel away from home?
- Which shelves do you use most often?
- Is there a shelf in your home that you would like to change?
- Do you ever whistle?
- Is it easy for you to recognise a tune when someone whistles it?

Part 2

Describe a person who asks useful questions.

You should say:

- who the person is
- what kinds of questions the person asks
- a situation in which a question helped

and explain why the person’s questions are useful.

- Do you find it easy to answer this person’s questions?
- Would you like to become better at asking questions yourself?

Part 3

- How can asking questions improve learning?
- How should a leader respond when an employee challenges an established practice?
- What role should public questions play in government decisions?
- Will the ability to ask good questions become more valuable in the future?

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Objective answer sheets

Listening

1		21	
2		22	
3		23	
4		24	
5		25	
6		26	
7		27	
8		28	
9		29	
10		30	
11		31	
12		32	
13		33	
14		34	
15		35	
16		36	
17		37	
18		38	
19		39	
20		40	

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Reading

1		21	
2		22	
3		23	
4		24	
5		25	
6		26	
7		27	
8		28	
9		29	
10		30	
11		31	
12		32	
13		33	
14		34	
15		35	
16		36	
17		37	
18		38	
19		39	
20		40	

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Writing response paper

Task 1 - response page 1 of 2

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Task 1 - response page 2 of 2

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Task 2 - response page 1 of 3

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Task 2 - response page 2 of 3

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Task 2 - response page 3 of 3

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Speaking notes

Use notes only for the permitted preparation time.

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